

Tobias Treppmann

Design systems shaped by how the organization actually works

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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PORTFOLIO

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Design systems

DTCG design tokens · Style Dictionary · Storybook · Figma variables and live library sync · multi-platform token pipelines · component APIs and specifications · design systems built to stay intact under AI-assisted work · governance and contribution paths

Accessibility

EU Accessibility Act audits · WCAG contrast checked in code · screen-reader semantics and ARIA · AI-generated alt text in production across six countries

Building and tools

Prototyping in real code against production APIs · Android and Kotlin · Swift UI · React and web · Claude Code, Cursor and Zed as daily tools

Governance and strategy

Tools, governance and workflows · integrating new technology into how a team works · design strategy tied to business and product goals · change management across functions · mentoring designers outside a reporting line

PROFILE

Head of Product Design at Bibel TV, where the design system across iOS, Android, web and connected TV is mine. A platform-agnostic token API, DTCG in four tiers: Figma, Android and web consume it today, and adding a platform is an implementation task rather than a change to the system. The people building with it are product managers and external engineers, which is why the component and view tiers exist: spacing, type size and radius change in the token API rather than in an agency ticket. Design-system governance at Ninox and component specifications at Datameer before that.

Enforced in the build

checks in CI refuse a token reference that does not resolve, or a color written straight into a component

Accessibility in code

WCAG contrast validated inside the color algorithm, and an EU Accessibility Act audit that covered the sites customers build

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- Standardization and flexibility, held apart by architecture — component and view tiers that alias downward and add no new values, so product teams get room on a shared foundation without the primitives moving.
- The external engineering agency backed it — it takes billable work away from them. The tiers are a step toward server-driven UI for the streaming app.
- Self-serve for product managers, engineers and AI assistants — Storybook as the shared surface, with the token vocabulary handed to the assistant as an enumerated list rather than recalled, so the compliant path is the fast one.
- Enforcement in the build — checks in CI reject a token reference that does not resolve, or a color written in by hand. Neither is a visual difference, so nothing else catches them.
- Color engine in production — themes built from content artwork, with WCAG contrast validated inside the algorithm.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- EU Accessibility Act compliance — we audited our own site and the sites customers build on the platform. Those are made by parish staff, so the standard had to hold without them.
- AI-generated alt text, shipped — across six countries, under GDPR plus church data-protection law.
- Booking module — the plan was a standalone add-on; I argued for building it into the platform and delivered it that way. 70% less coordination time, 90% acceptance.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Shared design-system governance — a working group of four designers and engineering, with a clear path for settling disagreements. Motion carried in the system as shared easing curves.
- Ran design and product at the same time — for four months, nine people across design, UX writing, product management and data science, on the senior leadership team. Hired two, promoted two.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Turned a services business into a product catalog — with the executive team of a listed group, and ran the design-thinking training for leadership.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Defined how components behaved — what each one did, what it guaranteed and where it could be used, across the design system library.
- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years, setting the design bar across both sites.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade reviewing and critiquing designers' work

Mentor · *Interaction Design Foundation* · 2020 – 2022 · Remote

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany · 200+ people

Earlier · *UX Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer* · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA